

Linda Mhalla

Senior Researcher

Department of Operations, HEC Lausanne
1015 Lausanne, Switzerland
☎ +41 78 605 94 63
✉ linda.mhalla@unil.ch
🌐 lindamhalla.netlify.com
DOB: January 22, 1990

Professional experience

- Sep 2020–now **Senior Researcher**, Department of Operations, HEC Lausanne, Switzerland.
- Sep 2018–Aug 2020 **Postdoctoral researcher**, Department of Decision Sciences, HEC Montreal, Canada.
- 2014–2018 **Teaching assistant**, Geneva School of Economics and Management, University of Geneva, Switzerland.
- Sep 2013–Jan 2014 **Intern in statistical analysis of ozone data**, Federal Office of Meteorology and Climatology MeteoSwiss, Switzerland.

Education

- 2014–2018 **PhD in Statistics**, University of Geneva, Switzerland.
Statistical modelling and inference for covariate-dependent extremal dependence.
Supervised by Prof. Valérie Chavez-Demoulin and Prof. Elvezio Ronchetti.
- 2012–2014 **MSc in Mathematical engineering (Statistics and Financial Mathematics)**, Ecole Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL), Switzerland.
Master thesis: Joint estimation for extremes of aggregated data.
Supervised by Prof. Anthony C. Davison.
- 2009–2012 **BSc in Mathematics**, Ecole Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL), Switzerland.
- 2008–2009 **Special Mathematics course (CMS, preparatory class)**, Ecole Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL), Switzerland.

Research grants

- Sep 2020–May 2021 **Swiss National Science Foundation, Postdoc.Mobility fellowship**
- Mar 2019–Sep 2020 **Swiss National Science Foundation, Early Postdoc.Mobility fellowship**
- Sep 2018–Mar 2019 **Statlab-INCASS-CRM postdoctoral fellowship**
- 2017 **Travel grant from Swiss Academy of Humanities and Social Sciences**
- 2016 **Travel grant from Société Académique de Genève**
- 2016 **Travel grant from Fondation Ernst et Lucie Schmidheiny**

Academic service

- 2021 **Co-organizer of the the Banff workshop on “Combining Causal Inference and Extreme Value Theory in the Study of Climate Extremes and their Causes”**
- 2015–2018 **Representative of the PhD candidates** at Conférence Universitaire de Suisse Occidentale (CUSO)
- 2017 **Co-organizer of the CUSO Young Researchers Conference**

Teaching experience and supervision of junior researchers

- Feb 2021–Jun 2021 Department of Operations, HEC Lausanne, Switzerland
Lecturer: "Statistiques II" for Bachelor students
- Mar 2020–Dec 2020 Co-supervisor with Prof. Marco Bee (University of Trento) and Prof. Valérie Chavez-Demoulin (HEC Lausanne) of Fabio Fusato, a MSc student in Mathematics
- Mar 2020–Sep 2020 Co-supervisor with Prof. Valérie Chavez-Demoulin and Eric Jondeau (HEC Lausanne) of Kevin Billy, a MSc student in Finance
- Dec 2019–now Co-supervisor with Prof. David Ardia (HEC Montréal) of Jaime Casigay, a MSc student in Financial Engineering
- Jan 2020–Apr 2020 Department of Decision Sciences, HEC Montréal, Canada
Lecturer: "Analyse et inférence statistique" for Master students in Management
- 2014–2018 Geneva School of Economics and Management, University of Geneva, Switzerland
Teaching assistant:
- Multivariate analysis for Master students in Statistics and Economics
 - Sampling techniques for Master students in Statistics and Economics
 - Probability and statistics for Bachelor students in Economics and Management
 - Mathematics II for Bachelor students in Economics and Management
- 2009–2014 Ecole Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL), Switzerland
Teaching assistant:
- Mathematical analysis for Bachelor students in Mechanical Engineering and Electrical Engineering
 - Mathematical analysis for students in Polymaths (Preparatory Course)
 - Mathematical analysis for students in CMS (Preparatory Course)

Publications

- 2021+ V. Chavez-Demoulin, E. Jondeau, and **L. Mhalla**. Climate-related disasters and death toll. Available at https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=3918201
- 2021 **L. Mhalla**, J. Hambuckers, and M. Lambert. Extremal connectedness of hedge funds. Accepted in Journal of Applied Econometrics and available at https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=3519295
- 2021+ **L. Mhalla** and T. Opitz. Discrete dependent extremes. In preparation.
- 2021+ **L. Mhalla** and D.J. Dupuis. Tracking changes in spatiotemporal extreme precipitation patterns during hurricane season. In preparation.
- 2020 **L. Mhalla**. Discussion of "Graphical models for extremes" by Sebastian Engelke and Adrien S. Hitz. Journal of the Royal Statistical Society: Series B **82**, 871–932.
- 2021 D. Castro-Camilo, **L. Mhalla** and T. Opitz. Bayesian space-time gap filling for inference on extreme hot-spots: an application to Red Sea surface temperatures. Extremes **24**, 105–128
- 2020 **L. Mhalla**, V. Chavez-Demoulin, and D.J. Dupuis. Causal mechanism of extreme river discharges in the upper Danube basin network. Journal of the Royal Statistical Society: Series C **69**, 741–764.

- 2019 **L. Mhalla**, M. de Carvalho, and V. Chavez-Demoulin. Regression type models for extremal dependence. *Scandinavian Journal of Statistics* **46**, 1141–1167.
- 2019 **L. Mhalla**, T. Opitz, and V. Chavez-Demoulin. Exceedance-based nonlinear regression of tail dependence. *Extremes* **22**, 523–552.
- 2017 **L. Mhalla**, V. Chavez-Demoulin, and Philippe Naveau. Non-linear models for extremal dependence. *Journal of Multivariate Analysis* **159**, 49–66.

Refereeing for peer-reviewed journals

Journal of the American Statistical Association (JASA)

Environmetrics

Annals of Applied Statistics

ESAIM: Probability and Statistics

Scandinavian Journal of Statistics

Statistics and Computing

Oral presentations at conferences and seminars

- Jun 2021 **Invited virtual talk**, 11th International Conference on Extreme Value Analysis.
- Oct 2020 **Invited virtual talk**, "Meet a GERAD researcher!" seminars.
- Mar 2020 **Invited talk**, Department of Decision Sciences, HEC Montréal (Montréal, Canada).
- Dec 2019 **Invited talk**, 12th International Conference on Computational and Methodological Statistics (ERCIM) (London, United Kingdom).
- Oct 2019 **Invited talk**, Fall Meeting of Statlab, University of Montréal (Montréal, Canada).
- July 2019 **Contributed talk**, 11th International Conference on Extreme Value Analysis (Zagreb, Croatia).
- June 2019 **Invited talk**, Operations Research Seminar, HEC Lausanne (Lausanne, Switzerland).
- June 2019 **Invited talk**, Workshop on Causality and Extremes, EPFL (Lausanne, Switzerland).
- Apr 2019 **Invited talk**, Département des mathématiques, Université de Sherbrooke (Québec, Canada).
- Feb 2019 **Invited talk**, Department of Mathematics and Statistics, Université Laval (Québec, Canada).
- Dec 2018 **Invited talk**, 11th International Conference on Computational and Methodological Statistics (ERCIM) (Pisa, Italy).
- Dec 2017 **Invited talk**, 10th International Conference on Computational and Methodological Statistics (ERCIM) (London, United Kingdom).
- Jun 2017 **Contributed talk**, 10th International Conference on Extreme Value Analysis (Delft, the Netherlands).
- Jun 2017 **Internal seminar**, Young Researchers Conference (Lausanne, Switzerland).
- Feb 2017 **Contributed talk**, Workshop on Risk Quantification and Extreme Values in Applications (Lausanne, Switzerland).
- Jun 2016 **Internal seminar**, Young Researchers Conference (Lausanne, Switzerland).
- Dec 2016 **Invited talk**, 9th International Conference on Computational and Methodological Statistics (ERCIM) (Sevilla, Spain).

Apr 2016 **Invited talk**, Workshop on Uncertainty and Causality Assessment in Modeling Extreme and Rare Events (Boulder, USA).

Languages

Fluent English
Bilingual French
Native Arabic

Hobbies

Travelling, Baking, and Tennis